# Wi-Fi troubleshooting: disconnects and no internet

Article KB0010020 | Owner: Network Support | Subcategory: Wi-Fi | Applies to: Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840, MacBook Pro/Air, Windows 11 23H2/24H2, macOS 14/15, Acme-Corp Wi-Fi (802.1X), Palo Alto GlobalProtect VPN (if used)

## Summary

This article guides users and service-desk agents through diagnosing and resolving common Wi-Fi problems on Acme Global laptops-intermittent disconnections, loss of internet after connecting, repeated credential prompts, and poor performance in meeting rooms. It outlines quick checks, a self-help procedure end-users can follow, a detailed troubleshooting flow for Network Support agents, verification steps, and preventive tips to reduce recurrence.

## Symptoms

- Wi-Fi drops or disconnects several times per hour
- Shows "Connected" but no internet access - browsers timeout, ping fails
- Repeated prompts for ACME-Corp password even after correct entry
- Very low throughput or high latency in specific meeting rooms
- Event Viewer shows NETIO or WLAN AutoConfig errors such as 0x80070005 or 0xC000000E

## Common causes

- Expired or corrupted machine certificate used for 802.1X authentication
- Power-saving settings that turn off the wireless adapter
- Out-of-date or incompatible Wi-Fi driver
- Interference or AP overload in dense areas
- VPN client holding onto old routing tables after disconnect
- Misconfigured DNS or stale DHCP lease

## Quick Initial Checks

Before diving into deeper troubleshooting, verify the basics that often resolve the issue quickly. Ensure airplane mode is off and the Wi-Fi toggle is enabled. Look at the Wi-Fi icon: does it show full bars, limited connectivity, or an exclamation mark? If you see a yellow triangle, note the tooltip - it may indicate "No internet" or "Limited". Try opening a browser to a known external site (e.g., https://www.microsoft.com) and an internal site (e.g., the Acme intranet). If both fail, the problem is likely at the link layer; if only internal sites fail, consider DNS or VPN issues.

## Self-Help Procedure for Users

Follow these steps to reset your wireless connection and clear common glitches. They are safe to perform on any Acme-managed laptop and do not require admin privileges.

1. 1. Click the Wi-Fi icon in the system tray (or menu bar on macOS) and select "ACME-Corp". Choose "Forget" or "Remove this network".
2. 2. Wait 10 seconds, then re-select "ACME-Corp" from the list of available networks.
3. 3. When prompted, enter your Acme username (format: first.last@acme.example) and password. If you use a smart card or certificate, ensure the correct certificate is selected.
4. 4. After connecting, open a command prompt (Windows) or Terminal (macOS) and run `ipconfig /renew` (Windows) or `sudo dhclient -renew` (macOS) to obtain a fresh DHCP lease.
5. 5. Test connectivity by pinging `8.8.8.8` and an internal resource such as `intranet.acme.example`. If both succeed, the issue is resolved.
6. 6. If the problem persists, proceed to the next section or contact the IT Service Desk via phone ext. 4357, the Teams "IT Help" channel, or the self-service portal.

## Service Desk Troubleshooting Procedure (Network Support)

When a user reports persistent Wi-Fi drops or no-internet after self-help, follow this structured flow. Document each step in the ticket and use the appropriate tools (Netsh, WifiLog, Intune device view, etc.).

1. 1. Verify the device's compliance status in Intune - ensure the wireless profile is present and the machine certificate is

valid (check expiration date).
2. 2. Collect a wireless log: on Windows run `netsh wlan show drivers` to confirm driver version and supported radio types; then enable logging with `netsh wlan set tracing yes` and reproduce the issue for 2-3 minutes, finally disable tracing and copy `%ProgramData%\\Microsoft\\WlanService\\Logs\\WlanTrace.etl` for analysis.
3. 3. On macOS, use `sudo wifiutil --log` or Console.app to capture Wi-Fi events.
4. 4. Examine the log for authentication failures (EAP-TLS errors), deauthentication reason codes, or frequent roaming events.
5. 5. If the machine certificate is expired or corrupted, initiate a certificate renewal request via the Intune device action "Renew certificate" or instruct the user to re-enroll via the Company Portal.
6. 6. Check power-settings: ensure the wireless adapter's power-saving option is disabled (`Device Manager -> Network Adapter -> Properties -> Power Management -> Uncheck "Allow the computer to turn off this device to save power"`). Push a compliance policy if needed.
7. 7. Validate driver version against the approved baseline (e.g., Intel Wi-Fi 6 AX201 22.XX.XX). If out-of-date, push the latest driver via Intune or instruct the user to install from Company Portal.
8. 8. Test with a known-good access point: move the user to a different conference room or use a personal hotspot to isolate AP-side issues.
9. 9. If all laptop-side checks pass, escalate to the Wireless-LAN team for AP health, channel utilization, or controller firmware review.

## Verification and Confirmation

After applying fixes, confirm that the connection is stable and that the user can resume normal work. Ask the user to perform a short validation test and document the results.

1. 1. Have the user stay connected for at least 15 minutes while performing typical tasks (Outlook, Teams, file sync).
2. 2. Run a continuous ping to `8.8.8.8` and an internal server (e.g., `filesrv01.acme.example`) and note any packet loss or latency spikes (>100?ms).
3. 3. Verify that the Wi-Fi icon shows full bars and no warning symbols.
4. 4. Confirm that the user can access both internet and intranet resources without credential prompts.
5. 5. Close the ticket with a resolution note summarizing the root cause (e.g., "Expired machine certificate renewed; power-saving disabled") and the steps taken.

## Prevention and Best Practices

To reduce repeat incidents, encourage users and administrators to adopt these proactive measures.

1. 1. Enable Intune compliance policies that enforce wireless adapter power-saving disabled and up-to-date drivers.
2. 2. Schedule quarterly checks of machine certificate expiry; automate renewal reminders via Intune.
3. 3. Educate users to use the "Forget network" option only when experiencing connectivity issues, not as a routine habit.
4. 4. In high-density areas (meeting rooms, auditoriums), work with the Wireless-LAN team to ensure sufficient AP capacity and proper channel planning.
5. 5. Advise users to disconnect from the GlobalProtect VPN when not needed, as stale VPN routes can interfere with local Wi-Fi traffic.

## When to escalate

If the laptop-side troubleshooting (certificate validity, driver, power settings, logs) does not resolve the issue after two cycles, escalate to the Wireless-LAN sub-team within Network Support. Provide the following details in the escalation ticket: device model, OS build, Intune compliance status, wireless log excerpt (or link to collected .etl file), certificate expiration timestamp, and a description of the observed failure pattern (e.g., deauthentication reason code 4, frequent roaming, or DHCP lease renewal failures). The Wireless-LAN team will assess AP health, controller logs, and RF interference in the affected area.

*Keywords: Wi-Fi disconnect, no internet, ACME-Corp password prompt, wireless drops, 802.1X, machine certificate, power saving, Wi-Fi driver, GlobalProtect, VPN, DHCP renewal, Intune compliance, Network Support*